

'No; one of your musketeers' horses.'

'Very well, sire. Is that all?'

'And you will accompany me.'

'Alone?'

'Alone.'

'Shall I come to seek your majesty, or shall I wait?'

'You will wait for me.'

'Where, sire?'

'At the little park-gate.'

The lieutenant bowed, understanding that the king had told him all he had to say. In fact, the king dismissed him with a gracious wave of the hand. The officer left the chamber of the king, and returned to place himself philosophically in his fauteuil, where, far from sleeping, as might have been expected, considering how late it was, he began to reflect more deeply than he had ever reflected before. The result of these reflections was not so melancholy as the preceding ones had been.

'Come, he has begun,' said he. 'Love urges him on, and he goes forward—he goes forward! The king is nobody in his own palace; but the man perhaps may prove to be worth something. Well, we shall see to-morrow morning. Oh! oh!' cried he, all at once starting up, 'that is a gigantic idea, *mordoux!* and perhaps my fortune depends, at least, upon that idea! After this exclamation, the officer arose and marched, with his hands in the pockets of his *justaucorps*, about the immense ante-chamber that served him as an apartment. The wax-light flamed furiously under the effects of a fresh breeze, which strolled in through the chinks of the door and the window, and cut the *salle* diagonally. It threw out a reddish, unequal light, sometimes brilliant, sometimes dull, and the tall shadow of the lieutenant was seen marching on the wall, in profile, like a figure by Callot, with his long sword and feathered hat.

'Certainly?' said he, 'I am mistaken if Mazarin is not laying a snare for this amorous boy. Mazarin, this evening, gave an address, and made an appointment as complacently as M. Dangeau himself could have done—I heard him, and I know the meaning of his words. "To-morrow morning," said he, "they will pass opposite the bridge of Blois." *Mordoux!* that is clear enough, and particularly for a lover. That is the cause of this embarrassment; that is the cause of this hesitation; that is the cause of

this order—"Monsieur the lieutenant of my musketeers, be on horseback to-morrow at four o'clock in the morning." Which is as clear as if he had said,—"*Monsieur* the lieutenant of my musketeers, to-morrow, at four, at the bridge of Blois,—do you understand?" Here is a state secret, then, which I, humble as I am, have in my possession, while it is in action. And how do I get it? Because I have good eyes, as his majesty just now said. They say he loves this little Italian doll furiously. They say he threw himself at his mother's feet, to beg her to allow him to marry her. They say the queen went so far as to consult the court of Rome, whether such a marriage, contracted against her will, would be valid. Oh, if I were but twenty-five! If I had by my side those I no longer have! If I did not despise the whole world most profoundly, I would embroil Mazarin with the queen-mother, France with Spain, and I would make a queen after my own fashion. But let that pass.' And the lieutenant snapped his fingers in disdain.

'This miserable Italian—this poor creature—this sordid wretch—who has just refused the king of England a million, would not perhaps give me a thousand pistoles for the news I would carry him. *Mordoux!* I am falling into second childhood—I am becoming stupid indeed! The idea of Mazarin giving anything! ha! ha! ha!' and he laughed in a subdued voice.

'Well, let us go to sleep—let us go to sleep; and the sooner the better. My mind is wearied with my evening's work, and will see things to-morrow more clearly than to-day.'

And upon this recommendation, made to himself, he folded his cloak around him, looking with contempt upon his royal neighbour. Five minutes after this he was asleep, with his hands clenched and his lips apart, giving escape, not to his secret, but to a sonorous sound, which rose and spread freely beneath the majestic roof of the ante-chamber.

opportunity. Now, this evening, they saw that your majesty coloured with endeavouring to conceal the inclination to yawn, that your majesty looked with eloquent supplications, first to his eminence, and then at her majesty, the queen-mother, and at length to the entrance door, and they so thoroughly remarked all I have said, that they saw your majesty's lips articulate these words: "Who will get me out of this?"

'Monsieur!'

'Or something to this effect, sire—"My musketeers!" I could then no longer hesitate. That look was for me. I cried out instantly, "His majesty's musketeers!" And, besides, that was shown to be true, sire, not only by your majesty's not saying I was wrong, but proving I was right by going out at once.'

The king turned away to smile; then, after a few seconds, he again fixed his limpid eye upon that countenance, so intelligent, so bold, and so firm, that it might have been said to be the proud and energetic profile of the eagle facing the sun. 'That is all very well,' said he, after a short silence, during which he endeavoured, in vain, to make his officer lower his eyes.

But seeing the king said no more, the latter pirouetted on his heels, and took three steps towards the door, muttering, 'He will not speak! *Mordieu!* he will not speak!'

'Thank you, monsieur,' said the king at last.

'Humph!' continued the lieutenant; 'there was only wanting that. Blamed for having been less of a fool than another might have been.' And he went to the door, allowing his spurs to jingle in true military style. But when he was on the threshold, feeling the king's desire drew him back, he returned.

'Has your majesty told me all?' asked he, in a tone we cannot describe, but which, without appearing to solicit the royal confidence, contained so much persuasive frankness, that the king immediately replied:

'Yes; but draw near, monsieur.'

'Now then,' murmured the officer, 'he is coming to it at last.'

'Listen to me.'

'I shall not lose a word, sire.'

'You will mount on horseback to-morrow, at about half-past four in the morning, and you will have a horse saddled for me.'

'From your majesty's stables?'

not be there. My duty and the peace of my conscience before everything, sire.'

'But such duty will kill you, monsieur.'

'Eh! sire, I have performed it for thirty years, and in all France and Navarre there is not a man in better health than I am. Moreover, I entreat you, sire, not to trouble yourself about me. That would appear very strange to me, seeing that I am not accustomed to it.'

The king cut short the conversation by a fresh question. 'Shall you be here, then, to-morrow morning?'

'As at present? yes, sire.'

The king walked several times up and down his chamber; it was very plain that he burned with a desire to speak, but that he was restrained by some fear or other. The lieutenant, standing motionless, hat in hand, watched him making these evolutions, and, whilst looking at him, grumbled to himself, biting his moustache:

'He has not half a crown worth of resolution! Parole d'honneur! I would lay a wager he does not speak at all!'

The king continued to walk about, casting from time to time a side glance at the lieutenant. 'He is the very image of his father,' continued the latter, in a secret soliloquy, 'he is at once proud, avaricious, and timid. The devil take his master, say I.'

The king stopped. 'Lieutenant,' said he.

'I am here, sire.'

'Why did you cry out this evening, down below in the salons—"The king's service! His majesty's musketeers!"'

'Because you gave me the order, sire.'

'I?' 'Yourself.'

'Indeed, I did not say a word, monsieur.'

'Sire, an order is given by a sign, by a gesture, by a glance, as intelligibly as freely, and as clearly as by word of mouth. A servant who has nothing but ears is not half a good servant.'

'Your eyes are very penetrating, then, monsieur.'

'How is that, sire?'

'Because they see what is not.'

'My eyes are good, though, sire, although they have served their master long and much: when they have anything to see, they seldom miss the

Chapter XIII

Mary de Mancini



HE sun had scarcely shed its first beams on the majestic trees of the park and the lofty turrets of the castle, when the young king, who had been awake more than two hours, possessed by the sleeplessness of love, opened his shutters himself, and cast an inquiring look into the courts of the sleeping palace. He saw that it was the hour agreed upon: the great court clock pointed to a quarter past four. He did not disturb his valet de chambre, who was sleeping soundly at some distance; he dressed himself, and the valet, in a great fright, sprang up, thinking he had been deficient in his duty; but the king sent him back again, commanding him to preserve the most absolute silence. He then descended the little staircase, went out at a lateral door, and perceived at the end of the wall a mounted horseman, holding another horse by the bridle. This horseman could not be recognized in his cloak and slouched hat. As to the horse, saddled like that of a rich citizen, it offered nothing remarkable to the most experienced eye. Louis took the bridle: the officer held the stirrup without dismounting, and asked his majesty's orders in a low voice.

'Follow me,' replied the king.

The officer put his horse to the trot, behind that of his master, and they descended the hill towards the bridge. When they reached the other side of the Loire,—

'Monsieur,' said the king, 'you will please to ride on till you see a carriage coming; then return and inform me. I will wait here.'

'Will your majesty deign to give me some description of the carriage I am charged to discover?'

'A carriage in which you will see two ladies, and probably their attendants likewise.'

'Sire, I should not wish to make a mistake; is there no other sign by which I may know this carriage?'

'It will bear, in all probability, the arms of monsieur le cardinal.'

'That is sufficient, sire,' replied the officer, fully instructed in the object of his search. He put his horse to the trot, and rode sharply on in the direction pointed out by the king. But he had scarcely gone five hundred paces when he saw four mules, and then a carriage, loom up from behind a little hill. Behind this carriage came another. It required only one glance to assure him that these were the equipages he was in search of; he therefore turned his bridle, and rode back to the king.

'Sire,' said he, 'here are the carriages. The first, as you said, contains two ladies with their femmes de chambre; the second contains the footmen, provisions, and necessities.'

'That is well,' replied the king in an agitated voice. 'Please to go and tell those ladies that a cavalier of the court wishes to pay his respects to them alone.'

The officer set off at a gallop. '*Mordieu!*' said he, as he rode on, 'here is a new and honourable employment, I hope! I complained of being nobody. I am the king's confidant: that is enough to make a musketeer burst with pride.'

He approached the carriage, and delivered his message gallantly and intelligently. There were two ladies in the carriage: one of great beauty, although rather thin; the other less favoured by nature, but lively, graceful, and uniting in the delicate lines of her brow all the signs of a strong will. Her eyes, animated and piercing, in particular, spoke more eloquently than all the amorous phrases in fashion in those days of gallantry. It was to her D'Artagnan addressed himself, without fear of being mistaken, although the other was, as we have said, the more handsome of the two.

'Madame,' said he, 'I am the lieutenant of the musketeers, and there is on the road a horseman who awaits you, and is desirous of paying his respects to you.'

At these words, the effect of which he watched closely, the lady with the black eyes uttered a cry of joy, leant out of the carriage window, and seeing the cavalier approaching, held out her arms, exclaiming:

Chapter XII

The King and the Lieutenant



As soon as the king saw the officer enter, he dismissed his valet de chambre and his gentleman.

'Who is on duty to-morrow, monsieur?' asked he.

The lieutenant bowed his head with military politeness, and replied, 'I am, sire.'

'What! still you?'

'Always I, sire.'

'How can that be, monsieur?'

'Sire, when travelling, the musketeers supply all the posts of your majesty's household; that is to say, yours, her majesty the queen's, and monsieur le cardinal's, the latter of whom borrows of the king the best part, or rather the numerous part, of the royal guard.'

'But in the interims?'

'There are no interims, sire, but for twenty or thirty men who rest out of a hundred and twenty. At the Louvre it is very different, and if I were at the Louvre I should rely upon my brigadier; but, when travelling, sire, no one knows what may happen, and I prefer doing my duty myself.'

'Then you are on guard every day?'

'And every night. Yes, sire.'

'Monsieur, I cannot allow that—I will have you rest.'

'That is very kind, sire; but I will not.'

'What do you say?' said the king, who did not at first comprehend the full meaning of this reply.

'I say, sire, that I will not expose myself to the chance of a fault. If the devil had a trick to play on me, you understand, sire, as he knows the man with whom he has to deal, he would chose the moment when I should

staircase with the unfortunate king, holding in his left hand his hat, the plume of which swept the steps. Arrived at the door, the musketeer asked the king which way he was going, that he might direct the musketeers.

‘Monsieur,’ replied Charles II, in a subdued voice, ‘you who have known my father, say, did you ever pray for him? If you have done so, do not forget me in your prayers. Now, I am going alone, and beg of you not to accompany me, or have me accompanied any further.’

The officer bowed and sent away the musketeers into the interior of the palace. But he himself remained an instant under the porch watching the departing Charles II, till he was lost in the turn of the next street. ‘To him as to his father formerly,’ murmured he, ‘Athos, if he were here, would say with reason,—“Salute fallen majesty!”’ Then, reascending the staircase: ‘Oh! the vile service that I follow!’ said he at every step. ‘Oh! my pitiful master! Life thus carried on is no longer tolerable, and it is at length time that I should do something! No more generosity, no more energy! The master has succeeded, the pupil is starved forever. *Mordiaux!* I will not resist. Come, you men,’ continued he, entering the ante-chamber, ‘why are you all looking at me so? Extinguish these torches and return to your posts. Ah! you were guarding me? Yes, you watch over me, do you not, worthy fellows? Brave fools! I am not the Duc de Guise. Begone! They will not assassinate me in the little passage. Besides,’ added he, in a low voice, ‘that would be a resolution, and no resolutions have been formed since Monsieur le Cardinal Richelieu died. Now, with all his faults, that was a man! It is settled: to-morrow I will throw my cassock to the nettles.’

Then, reflecting: ‘No,’ said he, ‘not yet! I have one great trial to make and I will make it; but that, and I swear it, shall be the last, *Mordiaux!*’

He had not finished speaking when a voice issued from the king’s chamber. ‘Monsieur le lieutenant!’ said this voice.

‘Here I am,’ replied he.

‘The king desires to speak to you.’

‘Humph!’ said the lieutenant; ‘perhaps of what I was thinking about.’

And he went into the king’s apartment.

‘Ah, my dear sire!’ and the tears gushed from her eyes.

The coachman stopped his team; the women rose in confusion from the back of the carriage, and the second lady made a slight curtsy, terminated by the most ironical smile that jealousy ever imparted to the lips of woman.

‘Marie, dear Marie,’ cried the king, taking the hand of the black-eyed lady in both his. And opening the heavy door himself, he drew her out of the carriage with so much ardour, that she was in his arms before she touched the ground. The lieutenant, posted on the other side of the carriage, saw and heard all without being observed.

The king offered his arm to Mademoiselle de Mancini, and made a sign to the coachman and lackeys to proceed. It was nearly six o’clock; the road was fresh and pleasant; tall trees with their foliage still inclosed in the golden down of their buds, let the dew of morning filter from their trembling branches, like liquid diamonds; the grass was bursting at the foot of the hedges; the swallows having returned only a few days since, described their graceful curves between the heavens and the water; a breeze, laden with the perfumes of the blossoming woods, sighed along the road, and wrinkled the surface of the waters of the river; all these beauties of the day, all these perfumes of the plants, all these aspirations of the earth towards heaven, intoxicated the two lovers, walking side by side, leaning upon each other, eyes fixed upon eyes, hand clasping hand, and who, lingering as by a common desire, did not dare to speak, they had so much to say.

The officer saw that the king’s horse, in wandering this way and that, annoyed Mademoiselle de Mancini. He took advantage of the pretext of securing the horse to draw near them, and dismounting, walked between the two horses he led; he did not lose a single word or gesture of the lovers. It was Mademoiselle de Mancini who at length began.

‘Ah, my dear sire!’ said she, ‘you do not abandon me, then?’

‘No, Marie,’ replied the king; ‘you see I do not.’

‘I had so often been told, though, that as soon as we should be separated you would no longer think of me.’

‘Dear Marie, is it then to-day only that you have discovered we are surrounded by people interested in deceiving us?’

‘But then, sire, this journey, this alliance with Spain? They are going to marry you off!’

Louis hung his head. At the same time the officer could see the eyes of Marie de Mancini shine in the sun with the brilliancy of a dagger starting from its sheath. 'And you have done nothing in favour of our love?' asked the girl, after a silence of a moment.

'Ah! mademoiselle, how could you believe that? I threw myself at the feet of my mother; I begged her, I implored her; I told her all my hopes of happiness were in you; I even threatened—'

'Well?' asked Marie, eagerly.

'Well, the queen-mother wrote to the court of Rome, and received as answer, that a marriage between us would have no validity, and would be dissolved by the holy father. At length, finding there was no hope for us, I requested to have my marriage with the infanta at least delayed.'

'And yet that does not prevent your being on the road to meet her?'

'How can I help it? To my prayers, to my supplications, to my tears, I received no answer but reasons of state.'

'Well, well?'

'Well, what is to be done, mademoiselle, when so many wills are leagued against me?'

It was now Marie's turn to hang her head. 'Then I must bid you adieu forever,' said she. 'You know that I am being exiled, you know that I am going to be buried alive; you know still more that they want to marry me off, too.'

Louis became very pale, and placed his hand upon his heart.

'If I had thought that my life only had been at stake, I have been so persecuted that I might have yielded; but I thought yours was concerned, my dear sire, and I stood out for the sake of preserving your happiness.'

'Oh, yes! my happiness, my treasure!' murmured the king, more gallantly than passionately, perhaps.

'The cardinal might have yielded,' said Marie, 'if you had addressed yourself to him, if you had pressed him. For the cardinal to call the king of France his nephew! do you not perceive, sire? He would have made war even for that honour; the cardinal, assured of governing alone, under the double pretext of having brought up the king and given his niece to him in marriage—the cardinal would have fought all antagonists, overcome all obstacles. Oh, sire! I can answer for that. I am a woman, and I see clearly into everything where love is concerned.'

'Good-night, my lord,' said Louis XIV, 'I go away in despair.'

'But convinced, and that is all I desire, sire,' replied Mazarin.

The king made no answer, and retired quite pensive, convinced, not of all Mazarin had told him, but of one thing which he took care not to mention to him; and that was, that it was necessary for him to study seriously both his own affairs and those of Europe, for he found them very difficult and very obscure. Louis found the king of England seated in the same place where he had left him. On perceiving him, the English prince arose; but at the first glance he saw discouragement written in dark letters upon his cousin's brow. Then, speaking first, as if to facilitate the painful avowal that Louis had to make to him,—

'Whatever it may be,' said he, 'I shall never forget all the kindness, all the friendship you have exhibited towards me.'

'Alas!' replied Louis, in a melancholy tone, 'only barren good-will, my brother.'

Charles II became extremely pale; he passed his cold hand over his brow, and struggled for a few instants against a faintness that made him tremble. 'I understand,' said he at last, 'no more hope!'

Louis seized the hand of Charles II. 'Wait, my brother,' said he; 'precipitate nothing; everything may change; hasty resolutions ruin all causes; add another year of trial, I implore you, to the years you have already undergone. You have, to induce you to act now rather than at another time, neither occasion nor opportunity. Come with me, my brother; I will give you one of my residences, whichever you prefer, to inhabit. I, with you, will keep my eyes upon events; we will prepare. Come, then, my brother, have courage!'

Charles II withdrew his hand from that of the king, and drawing back, to salute him with more ceremony, 'With all my heart, thanks!' replied he, 'sire; but I have prayed without success to the greatest king on earth; now I will go and ask a miracle of God.' And he went out without being willing to hear any more, his head carried loftily, his hand trembling, with a painful contraction of his noble countenance, and that profound gloom which, finding no more hope in the world of men, appeared to go beyond it, and ask it in worlds unknown. The officer of musketeers, on seeing him pass by thus pale, bowed almost to his knees as he saluted him. He then took a flambeau, called two musketeers, and descended the deserted

a sepulchre! At this moment Monk is affecting devotion to the Rump Parliament; of this devotion, I am not the dupe. Monk has no wish to be assassinated,—an assassination would stop him in the middle of his operations; and his work must be accomplished;—so I believe—but do not believe what I believe, sire: for as I say I believe from habit—I believe that Monk is keeping on friendly terms with the parliament till the day comes for dispersing it. You are asked for swords, but they are to fight against Monk. God preserve you from fighting against Monk, sire; for Monk would beat us, and I should never console myself after being beaten by Monk. I should say to myself, Monk has foreseen that victory ten years. For God's sake, sire, out of friendship for you, if not out of consideration for himself, let Charles II keep quiet. Your majesty will give him a little income here; give him one of your châteaux. Yes, yes—wait awhile. But I forget the treaty—that famous treaty of which we were just now speaking. Your majesty has not even the right to give him a château.'

'How is that?'

'Yes, yes; your majesty is bound not to grant hospitality to King Charles, and to compel him to leave France even. It was on this account we forced him to quit you, and yet here he is again. Sire, I hope you will give your brother to understand that he cannot remain with us; that it is impossible he should be allowed to compromise us; or I myself—'

'Enough, my lord,' said Louis XIV, rising. 'In refusing me a million, perhaps you may be right; your millions are your own. In refusing me two hundred gentlemen, you are still further in the right; for you are prime minister, and you have, in the eyes of France, the responsibility of peace and war. But that you should pretend to prevent me, who am king, from extending my hospitality to the grandson of Henry IV, to my cousin-german¹, to the companion of my childhood—there your power stops, and there begins my will.'

'Sire,' said Mazarin, delighted at being let off so cheaply, and who had, besides, only fought so earnestly to arrive at that,— 'sire, I shall always bend before the will of my king. Let my king, then, keep near him, or in one of his châteaux, the king of England; let Mazarin know it, but let not the minister know it.'

¹First cousin.

These words produced a strange effect upon the king. Instead of heightening his passion, they cooled it. He stopped, and said hastily,— 'What is to be said, mademoiselle? Everything has failed.'

'Except your will, I trust, my dear sire?'

'Alas!' said the king, colouring, 'have I a will?'

'Oh!' said Mademoiselle de Mancini mournfully, wounded by that expression.

'The king has no will but that which policy dictates, but that which reasons of state impose upon him.'

'Oh! it is because you have no love,' cried Mary; 'if you loved, sire, you would have a will.'

On pronouncing these words, Mary raised her eyes to her lover, whom she saw more pale and more cast down than an exile who is about to quit his native land forever. 'Accuse me,' murmured the king, 'but do not say I do not love you.'

A long silence followed these words, which the young king had pronounced with a perfectly true and profound feeling. 'I am unable to think that to-morrow, and after to-morrow, I shall see you no more; I cannot think that I am going to end my sad days at a distance from Paris; that the lips of an old man, of an unknown, should touch that hand which you hold within yours; no, in truth, I cannot think of all that, my dear sire, without having my poor heart burst with despair.'

And Marie de Mancini did shed floods of tears. On his part, the king, much affected, carried his handkerchief to his mouth, and stifled a sob.

'See,' said she, 'the carriages have stopped, my sister waits for me, the time is come; what you are about to decide upon will be decided for life. Oh, sire! you are willing, then, that I should lose you? You are willing, then, Louis, that she to whom you have said "I love you," should belong to another than to her king, to her master, to her lover? Oh! courage, Louis! courage! One word, a single word! Say "I will!" and all my life is enchained to yours, and all my heart is yours forever.'

The king made no reply. Mary then looked at him as Dido looked at Aeneas in the Elysian fields, fierce and disdainful.

'Farewell, then,' said she; 'farewell life! love! heaven!'

And she took a step away. The king detained her, seizing her hand, which he pressed to his lips, and despair prevailing over the resolution he

appeared to have inwardly formed, he let fall upon that beautiful hand a burning tear of regret, which made Mary start, so really had that tear burnt her. She saw the humid eyes of the king, his pale brow, his convulsed lips, and cried, with an accent that cannot be described,—

‘Oh, sire! you are a king, you weep, and yet I depart!’

As his sole reply, the king hid his face in his handkerchief. The officer uttered something so like a roar that it frightened the horses. Mademoiselle de Mancini, quite indignant, quitted the king’s arm, hastily entered the carriage, crying to the coachman, ‘Go on, go on, and quick!’

The coachman obeyed, flogging his mules, and the heavy carriage rocked upon its creaking axle, whilst the king of France, alone, cast down, annihilated, did not dare to look either behind or before him.

ascertain what. Every morning, as Louis XI advised, he burns his nightcap. Therefore, on the day when this plan, slowly and solitarily ripened, shall break forth, it will break forth with all the conditions of success which always accompany an unforeseen event. That is Monk, sire, of whom, perhaps, you have never even heard—of whom, perhaps, you did not even know the name, before your brother, Charles II, who knows what he is, pronounced it before you. He is a marvel of depth and tenacity, the two only things against which intelligence and ardour are blunted. Sire, I had ardour when I was young; I always was intelligent. I may safely boast of it, because I am reproached with it. I have done very well with these two qualities, since, from the son of a fisherman of Piscina, I have become prime minister to the king of France; and in that position your majesty will perhaps acknowledge I have rendered some service to the throne of your majesty. Well, sire, if I had met with Monk on my way, instead of Monsieur de Beaufort, Monsieur de Retz, or Monsieur le Prince—well, we should have been ruined. If you engage yourself rashly, sire, you will fall into the talons of this politic soldier. The casque of Monk, sire, is an iron coffer, and no one has the key of it. Therefore, near him, or rather before him, I bow, sire, for I have nothing but a velvet cap.’

‘What do you think Monk wishes to do, then?’

‘Eh! sire, if I knew that, I would not tell you to mistrust him, for I should be stronger than he; but with him, I am afraid to guess—to guess!—you understand my word?—for if I thought I had guessed, I should stop at an idea, and, in spite of myself, should pursue that idea. Since that man has been in power yonder, I am like one of the damned in Dante whose neck Satan has twisted, and who walk forward looking around behind them. I am travelling towards Madrid, but I never lose sight of London. To guess, with that devil of a man, is to deceive one’s self and to deceive one’s self is to ruin one’s self. God keep me from ever seeking to guess what he aims at; I confine myself to watching what he does, and that is well enough. Now I believe—you observe the meaning of the word I believe?—I believe, with respect to Monk, ties one to nothing—I believe that he has a strong inclination to succeed Cromwell. Your Charles II has already caused proposals to be made to him by ten persons; he has satisfied himself with driving these ten meddlers from his presence, without saying anything to them but, “Begone, or I will have you hung.” That man is